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DYNAMITE®

TEEN+

SHERLOCK HOLMES™

THE VANISHING MAN

MOORE

REPPION

OHTA

SHERLOCK HOLMES™
THE VANISHING MAN

NO. 2

WRITTEN BY
LEAH MOORE & JOHN REPPION

ILLUSTRATED BY
JULIUS OHTA

COLORS BY
ELLIE WRIGHT

LETTERED BY
SIMON BOWLAND

EDITED BY
KEVIN KETNER

COVER BY
JOHN CASSADAY & JOSÉ VILLARRUBIA

DYNAMITE

Nick Barrucci, CEO / Publisher
Juan Collado, President / COO

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PEFC/01-31-106 www.pefc.org

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PAWNBROKERS

Gold and Silver bought and sold • Sable and

"ONCE MRS. WILLIAMS LEFT BAKER STREET, I FOLLOWED FOR NEAR TWO MILES.

"WE FINISHED AT A FANCY PAWNBROKERS, NO DOLLYSHOP NEITHER!

ilver bought and sold • Sable and

"MY THOUGHT WAS THE HUSBAND HAD THIEVED SOMETHING...

"...PUT IT *IN LAVENDER* AS IT WERE, OUTTA THE WAY OF THE POLICE?

"MAYBE THE MISSUS GETS HOLD OF THE TICKET AND COMES TO FIND HIS LOOT?

"WOULDN'T BE THE FIRST HUSBAND TO KEEP A SECRET THUS."

GOOD DAY, MADAM, CAN I HELP YOU WITH SOMETHING?

OH, YES. I DO HOPE YOU CAN.

DO YOU HAVE SOMETHING LIKE THAT, BUT SMALL ENOUGH FOR ME TO CARRY?

"SHE DIDN'T SHOW A TICKET, SO THEN I'M THINKIN' SHE'S PUTTING SOMETHIN' *IN*...

"...GIVIN' HER RINGS TO GET THE RENT, LIKE...

"...BUT HE GETS OUT A LITTLE IRON. DAINTY LITTLE THING IT WAS.

"I REGRET TO SAY, I LOST HER WHEN SHE HOPPED AN OMNIBUS."

HOLMES! WE HAVE ARTHUR RAFFLES HIMSELF, DOWN AT THE--

HOLMES?

MR. HOLMES IS NOT AT HOME, INSPECTOR. I DID ***TRY*** TO TELL YOU.

B-BUT HE'S BEEN MOULDERING ABOUT IN HERE FOR ***WEEKS!***

WHERE IS HE?

HE HAD A VISITOR, AND THEY LEFT NOT LONG AFTER.

TWO MONTHS ON THAT SOFA LIKE A BLOODY ***CONSUMPTIVE,*** AND NOW ***THIS?***

TELL HIM I NEED HIM AT CHANNEL ROW, MRS. HUDSON. THE ***MOMENT*** HE RETURNS!

OF COURSE, INSPECTOR. I'LL TELL HIM.

YES?

INSPECTOR LESTRADE! I'M AFRAID YOU WON'T BE ABLE TO--

I MUST ***INSIST,*** MRS. HUDSON! I KNOW HOW HE IS, BUT THIS CANNOT WAIT!

YOU'VE HEARD ABOUT THE BURGLARIES? ALL THROUGH KENSINGTON AND SUCH? THERE'S BEEN A DOZEN OR MORE ALL TOLD.

I'VE A CRACKSMAN IN THE STATION THAT MAY COP FOR THE LOT, IF I CAN BUT ***PROVE*** IT!

YES, BUT, INSPECTOR, YOU ***CAN'T,*** YOU SEE...

I'VE NEVER KNOWN A SUMMER LIKE IT, I AM DROWNING IN CRIMES! WAVE UPON WAVE OF 'EM!

INSPECTOR! YOU CAN'T...

GOOD AFTERNOON, SIRS. CAN I HELP YOU?

GOOD AFTERNOON. IS MRS. MAY WILLIAMS AT HOME?

MUM'S NOT HERE NO, BUT--

WHO IS IT, HENRY?

GO ALONG NOW, DEAR. HELP YOUR SISTER WITH HER LETTERS.

WHAT A POLITE FELLOW! EXCELLENT MANNERS.

MAY I HELP YOU, GENTLEMEN?

ARE YOU LOOKING FOR *MICHAEL?*

I AM SHERLOCK HOLMES AND THIS IS MY COMPANION DR. WATSON.

MRS. MAY WILLIAMS VISITED ME, SHE SAID HER HUSBAND IS *MISSING?*

SHE GAVE US THIS ADDRESS TO REACH HER AT.

SHE'S NOT HOME RIGHT NOW. SHE HAD SOME ***ERRANDS*** TO RUN.

COULD YOU CALL AGAIN, PERHAPS?

MAY WE ASK ***YOU*** A FEW QUESTIONS? MRS...?

FREEMAN. PHILOMENA FREEMAN. I AM MAY'S ***MOTHER.***

I CAN SPARE BUT A MINUTE OR TWO. GO ON AHEAD, GENTLEMEN. WE CAN TALK IN THE DRAWING ROOM.

WE ARE OBLIGED TO YOU, MADAM.

THE WORLD

BOTANICAL CHART

I HOPE WE AREN'T INTERRUPTING TOO--*OH!*

YOU KEEP GOING CHILDREN. RIGHT UP TO "*ZEE.*"

I SHAN'T BE LONG, THEN I'LL COME CHECK HOW Y'ALL HAVE DONE.

AN IMPRESSIVE LIBRARY!

IT PAINED YOU GREATLY TO SEE YOUR PARENTS STRUGGLE BECAUSE THEY WERE ***FORBIDDEN*** TO LEARN, AM I RIGHT?

THAT'S WHY YOU'VE TAKEN IN THOSE CHILDREN, AND SCHOOL THEM?

THEY WERE SLAVES IN GEORGIA. THEY DID THE BEST FOR ME THEY COULD.

HOW CAN I HELP YOU, MR. HOLMES? YOU KNOW ALREADY MICHAEL IS ***GONE.***

GONE?

MR. WILLIAMS HAS ONLY BEEN ABSENT A FEW DAYS. DO YOU NOT EXPECT HIM TO RETURN?

I HOPE AND I PRAY FOR HIS SAFE RETURN TO US, OF COURSE.

BUT IN THE MEANTIME, WE MUST KEEP THE HOUSE AND FEED THE CHILDREN!

ARE YOUR DAUGHTER AND HER HUSBAND ON GOOD TERMS?

DO THEY QUARREL? FIGHT? MOST COUPLES HAVE THEIR SPATS ***SOMETIMES.***

I SWEAR TO YOU THAT I HAVE NEVER ONCE HEARD A CROSS WORD PASS BETWEEN THEM, SIR.

WHEN WERE THEY MARRIED?

DO YOU LIKE SWEETS?

BEGGIN' YOUR PARDON, SIR, I--

I HAVE A BIT OF A SWEET TOOTH MYSELF.

OH... WHY...IT WAS A JUNE WEDDING, A LOVELY DAY INDEED.

SOME YEARS AGO. FIVE, OR IS IT SIX? IT ESCAPES ME, I'M AFRAID.

WONDERFUL THING TAKING IN THOSE CHILDREN. PUTTING A ROOF OVER THEIR HEADS.

MUST BE A COSTLY AFFAIR.

MICHAEL WAS...*IS*, ALWAYS HAS BEEN, A VERY HARD WORKER.

BUT YES, EVERY PENNY HE EARNS GOES TO RENT AND FOOD AND BOOKS FOR THE CHILDREN.

AND IF HIS WAGES AREN'T ENOUGH?

IS HE IN DEBT?

A GAMBLER, PERHAPS?

WHAT? NO. NEVER.

THERE ARE NO DEBTS, SAVE THE RENT AND EXPENSES EVERYONE MUST PAY.

AN *HONEST* MAN. A *HARD-WORKING* MAN. A *FAMILY* MAN.

IT SEEMS THAT OUR POOR, LOST MR. MICHAEL WILLIAMS IS QUITE PERFECT IN EVERY WAY.

Running a Thousand Miles for Freedom

or the Escape of William and Ellen Craft from Slavery

WOULD YOU CARE FOR SOME TURKISH DELIGHT?

N-NO, THANK YOU, SIR. VERY KIND OF YOU, I'M SURE.

I-I REALLY SHOULD BE GETTIN' BACK TO MY OWN BUSINESS, SIR.

PATIENCE, BOY.

YOU MAY SUPPLY YOUR MR. HOLMES WITH HIS SOLUTION YET, BUT IT SHALL BE AT A TIME OF ***MY*** CHOOSING.

WOAH THERE!

HERE WE ARE.

COME ALONG.

I HAVE BUSINESS OF MY OWN TO ATTEND TO.

IS THIS A PHOTOGRAPH OF MR. WILLIAMS?

IT IS, DOCTOR.

AND WHEN YOU SAW HIM LAST? HE HAS NOT SINCE GROWN WHISKERS OR SOME SUCH?

IF YOU MET HIM HE WOULD LOOK JUST SO. HE HAS NOT CHANGED ONE BIT.

AND DO YOU HAVE ANY IDEA WHERE WE ***MIGHT*** MEET YOUR SON-IN-LAW?

ANY LIKELY PLACES? A FAVOURITE ALE HOUSE, PERHAPS?

HE DOES NOT DRINK.

I ASK YOU, SIR, IF MAY OR I HAD AN IDEA WHERE HE MIGHT BE, WOULD WE NOT ***SEEK*** HIM THERE OURSELVES?

I HAD BETTER GET BACK TO THE CHILDREN NOW, IF YOU DON'T MIND.

OF COURSE. WELL, THANK YOU. IT HAS BEEN MOST INFORMATIVE.

I CAN'T RIGHTLY SEE HOW IT CAN HAVE BEEN SO, SIR.

Running a Thousand

for Freedom

IF I HEAR ANYTHING AT ALL, I WILL TELL YOU GENTLEMEN, YOU HAVE MY WORD ON IT!

DEAR LADY, I APOLOGIZE IF MY QUESTIONING HAS BEEN ***UNPLEASANT.***

UNDERSTAND THAT I WAS ENGAGED BY YOUR DAUGHTER, TO HELP YOU BOTH!

PLEASE TELL MRS. WILLIAMS WE SHALL CALL AGAIN TOMORROW.

WELL, HOLMES, WHAT DO YOU THINK?

I THINK THAT THE GENTLEMAN STANDING IN THE SAME SPOT HE WAS WHEN WE ARRIVED, IS MOST ASSUREDLY ***WATCHING*** THIS HOUSE.

HI! YOU THERE!

STOP!

COME, WATSON!

THERE'S NO TIME TO WASTE!

BOKAW!

OI! WHAT D'YER THINK YER PLAYIN' AT?

UNG

MY APOLOGIES.

KITCHEN

WHAT IN THE...?

YAP YAP YAP

HELL'S TEETH!

YAP YAP

OI! WHAT'RE YOU PLAYING AT?

YAP YAP

CHANNEL ROW POLICE STATION.

"INSPECTOR LESTRADE, SIR, I DIDN'T EXPECT TO SEE YOU BACK SO SOON?"

ANY WORD FROM HOLMES?

NO, SIR. NOTHING.

43.

BLOODY TYPICAL, NOW I ACTUALLY HAVE NEED OF HIM!

HE'D GET MORE OUT OF THE PRISONER THAN SPECIAL BRANCH DID.

THEY WEREN'T HERE BUT TEN MINUTES.

SPECIAL BRANCH?

18. 29

TURNED UP ALMOST AS SOON AS YOU LEFT, SIR. I THOUGHT--

WHO?

I-I DIDN'T RECOGNISE THEM, BUT THEY SHOWED ME--

YOU *IDIOT!*

SERGEANT!

SERGEANT!

AT LEAST THEY DIDN'T TAKE THE BLOODY KEYS.

KLIK

SERGEANT BAILEY?

WHAT THE HELL'S GOING ON?

BAILEY'S DEAD.

WHICH CELL? WHICH CELL?!

TH-THAT ONE, THERE.

I DON'T UNDERSTAND...

HE'S GONE.

THEY'VE TAKEN HIM.

HOLMES? *HOLMES?*

WHERE THE DEVIL HAVE THEY *GONE?*

HAVE TWO MEN RAN BY HERE?

NOT OUT HERE, NO, BUT...

SOHO
PIANOS & PIANOLAS

OVING VAN.

KASMASH

OHO

S & PIANO

NEIIIIGH!

STOP HIM!

WATSON!

HYAA!

"STOP HIM!"

HOW IS IT, YOUNG SIR?
ALL TO YOUR SATISFACTION?
MMM- FNKYOU!
GOOD. I'M GLAD TO HEAR IT.
I DO BELIEVE MY BUSINESS MAY BE OF INTEREST TO YOU.
YOU SEEM A BRIGHT YOUNG THING. KEEN TO LEARN.
AH! MY OTHER GUEST HAS ARRIVED.
PLEASE! LET ME GO! I DIDN'T TELL THEM ANYTHING! I SWEAR IT!
I DIDN'T... WH-WHO ARE YOU?
AH. WHO INDEED.
I AM A MAN WHO CANNOT AFFORD TO HAVE HIS INTERESTS COMPROMISED.

TODAY HAS BEEN A MOST SINGULAR DAY, WOULD YOU NOT AGREE?

WHAT DO YOU MAKE OF IT ALL, WATSON? I AM CURIOUS.

WELL, I SHOULD SAY THIS FELLOW WILLIAMS MUST BE UP TO SOMETHING. HE CAN'T BE AS PERFECT AS HE SOUNDS.

I WONDER IF HE HAS A ***PARAMOUR!***

DO YOU THINK? A GIRL FROM THE OFFICE?

DID MRS. WILLIAMS GIVE REASON TO SUSPECT THIS? WAS SHE UNHAPPY WITH HER HUSBAND?

NO, BUT THEY HAVE A GREAT DEAL OF CHILDREN! THAT PRESSURE CAN BE TOO MUCH FOR SOME MEN...

THE YOUNG LADIES IN WORK WOULD BE FREE FROM THOSE ***RESPONSIBILITIES.***

I ADMIT, HE WOULD NOT BE THE FIRST TO BE DRAWN BY SUCH CHARMS.

IT IS MY GUESS THAT HE HAS TAKEN A NEW HOME HERE IN LONDON WITH HIS ***FANCY WOMAN.***

LEAVING HIS POOR WIFE TO CARE FOR ALL THOSE CHILDREN AND KEEP A ROOF OVER THEIR HEADS!

FOR SHAME!

MANY, MANY PEOPLE RELY UPON ME, YOU SEE.

EVEN THOUGH THEY MAY NOT REALISE IT.

AND YOU. WHAT YOU KNOW. WHAT YOU MIGHT TELL...

HOW COULD I TELL ANYTHING ABOUT *YOU*? I DON'T KNOW WHO YOU ARE!

"YOU ARE A COG IN A MACHINE.

"THAT MACHINE BELONGS TO ME.

"THE MORE THAT IS KNOWN OF ITS WORKINGS--ITS DESIGN--THE CLOSER INTELLIGENT MEN MAY COME TO GUESSING ITS PURPOSE.

"AND ITS MAKER."

MY NAME IS PROFESSOR JAMES MORIARTY, AND NOW THAT YOU KNOW THAT, I'M AFRAID I CANNOT ALLOW YOU TO LIVE.

WHAT? I-I DON'T UNDERSTAND!

AAARGH!

EAT UP NOW, BOY. IT'LL BE STONE COLD.

MY DEAR FELLOW, YOU HAVE CLEARLY THOUGHT THIS THROUGH, AND HAVE EXPRESSED YOURSELF WELL.

I AM, HOWEVER, INCLINED TO BELIEVE YOU ARE UTTERLY, AND COMPLETELY, ***INCORRECT.***

MR. HOLMES? I HAVE PERFORMED THE SEARCHES YOU REQUESTED, BUT I CANNOT SAY I HAVE BEEN SUCCESSFUL.

SUCCESS IS SUBJECTIVE, MY DEAR. WHAT DID YOU ***FIND?***

I COULD NOT FIND A RECORD OF A MARRIAGE BETWEEN MICHAEL AND MAY WILLIAMS.

NOR COULD I FIND A BIRTH CERTIFICATE FOR MICHAEL WILLIAMS.

SO, THEY WERE *"LIVING IN SIN"*? MAYBE HE IS ALREADY MARRIED? A ***BIGAMIST!***

I DID FIND TAX RETURNS FOR MR. MICHAEL WILLIAMS, FILED BY HOOKHAM'S SOLICITORS.

APART FROM THAT, I COULD NOT FIND ANY TRACE OF HIM.

GOOD LORD, IT IS AS IF MICHAEL WILLIAMS WERE VANISHING BEFORE OUR VERY EYES.

SOMEONE STANDS TO BENEFIT FROM IT, WATSON. THAT IS THE KEY.

SOMEONE NEEDS MICHAEL WILLIAMS TO VANISH ***COMPLETELY.***

ALL ASLEEP, LITTLE PETS.

WELL, THERE'S A MERCY AT LEAST.

HE SAID HE WOULD CALL AGAIN. HOLMES.

IT IS ALL TO THE GOOD IF HE DOES COME AGAIN.

THE GREAT DETECTIVE MAY SEARCH THE WHOLE OF LONDON...

...BUT HE SHALL NOT FIND MICHAEL WILLIAMS.

DYNAMITE® DISPATCH JUNE 2018

NEXT ISSUE

Holmes inches closer to solving the disappearance of Michael Williams, but it also brings him closer to danger! Meanwhile, Moriarty's cunning scheme goes deeper than anyone anticipated, including the neighborhood boy caught in his clutches!

*ROB WILLIAMS TALKS SHOP WITH **DYNAMITE** ABOUT **PROJECT SUPERPOWERS:***

Project Superpowers is a unique property, pulling in a variety of Golden Age heroes originally published by different publishers. How familiar were you with these heroes before getting involved in the project? What made you want to do it?

To be honest, not enormously familiar, so a quick bout of research was the order of the day. I was aware of the Alex Ross - Krueger mini a few years back, and the Warren Ellis take. There's a bunch of fun to be had detailing a relatively new shared superhero universe. And I like the guys at Dynamite. So that appealed.

What can you tell us about your take on these characters and the themes of the upcoming series? Are we focused on a team of heroes or on a world full of heroes?

The cast in the Ross-Krueger series was vast, so I wanted to streamline them a bit. I've spent the last couple of years writing a team book for DC and I know how easy it is to lose the important character focus if it's an army of characters. So it was a case of choosing the team members that I thought I could have some fun with. And then it's really trying to make them feel contemporary and 2018. As you say, their origins are Golden Age. Their history is WW2 which makes them kind of Justice Society-esque in their DNA. I wanted to ask questions about the validity of superheroes in a non-binary world, where good and evil is a lot more fragmented than it was in the '40s. But most of all, it has to be exciting and a fun read.

There are a lot of characters you can use in this series, which ones did you focus on and why? And what about the threats they're facing? Are we doing to see any of the classic villains?

In our new #0 you'll see we're introducing the new world via The Devil (Death Defying) and Green Lama. We'll flash back to introduce new readers to the team's World War 2 origins and how they were brought to the present via imprisonment in pandora's box. And then it's introducing a brand new threat. One not so rooted in their history. The main players, which include The Scarab, Masquarede, Black Terror, are going to have to form a new incarnation of the team. And The Spirit Of the American Flag is hovering, watching, judging… A new host is going to be taken.

There have been a couple different approaches to this title, from the original run by Jim Krueger and Alex Ross, to Warren Elli's Black Cross run to Ryan Brown's Hero Killer. They have seemed to have different tones and style. Does your series play off any of the previous ones or are you building something new? Did the previous series influence you in anyway?

I'm going for classic superheroics with a contemporary feel. Treat it like we've just been given a Project Superpowers movie with a budget that would cripple a south american nation. This is a story with a definite start-middle-end.

Does your approach to writing change any when you're dealing with a group of heroes rather than working on a solo character? How does writing a script for Project Superheroes differ from Suicide Squad and how is it similar?

They're both team books and what isn't talked about enough is how hard team books are to write. How the bigger the cast gets, the harder it is to create emotion for the reader. Those classic runs we all love on Uncanny X-Men, Justice League International etc - that's some alchemy. I do think writing a solo character's book is easier. We know who the lead is. With a team book you have seven leads, and the moment you put the focus on one or two, you're ignoring the others.

There is a nostalgic appeal to these characters, but for many people they may have never seen them. In a sentence or two, why should someone who knows nothing about these characters want to pick up Superpowers #0?

Because if we do it right - and we're working on it - it'll remind you just how much fun superhero comics can be, and why they became so popular in the first place.

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SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN... THIS MONSTER!"